

SURYAKUMAR YADAV

It has been a wonderful journey over the last month. Though it didn't start the way we wanted it to start, it is part of the sport. Throughout the journey till today, it has been very special. Collectively as a team, what we have achieved, I think is right in front of you [trophy]. So, [I'm] very happy with that, and the next goal is the Olympic gold and also the team that we work with.

Everything changed post-2024. We played a different kind of cricket in 2024, and from there, we understood how this team needs to work forward, play forward, and it's been a wonderful journey since then. We won an ICC Champions Trophy in 2025, played a completely different kind of cricket, and now in 2026, we wanted to do something special in front of the home crowd. So we want to continue doing that in 2027, 2028, 2029 and never stop.

Jay Shah, Rohit (Sharma) *bhai*, they all showed faith in me and gave me the opportunity to lead. From there, it's been a long journey, coming here and winning it. We have been playing good cricket in the last two years, and we just wanted to follow the good cricketing habits that we had in the 2024 World Cup. The boys took it really well.

[On keeping faith in players] I think it's really important to understand what they are capable of. And I knew they had the match-winners in them. The timing was perfect. Sanju Samson and Abhishek Sharma are top players, and we knew they would do something special, and they did it in the final. [Jasprit] Bumrah is a once-in-a-generation bowler. I can call him a national treasure. He knows how it needs to be done. He is the best in the business.



VIJAY SONEJI